

Tagalog

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Abstract This chapter provides an overview of the behavior of second-position clitics in Tagalog (Filipino), an Austronesian language of the Philippines. We illustrate the second-position nature of their linear placement and describe the inventory of clitics (certain pronouns and a limited set of adverbs), and the linear ordering and semantic scope of clitics with respect to one another. On each of these topics, we highlight apparent and claimed generalizations as well as potential exceptions and challenges. We advocate for the view that the linear placement of these clitics must be determined postsyntactically, but constrained by certain syntactic domains. The existence of such second-position clitics is also one characteristic of the so-called Philippine-type subgroup of Austronesian languages. We therefore also point to salient cross-linguistic uniformities and points of variation amongst Philippine-type languages in relation to second-position clitic behavior.

Keywords Austronesian, Philippine-type, second-position clitics, pronominal clitics, adverbial clitics, syntactic domains, linear order, semantic scope

Acknowledgements To be added

1 Introduction

Austronesian languages of the Philippines are well-known for their inventory of second-position (Wackernagel) clitics, which include a restricted set of pronouns and adverbs.¹ This chapter will discuss the behavior of these second-position clitics, their inventory and more detailed interactions, and relevant theoretical questions. We will specifically concentrate on such facts in Tagalog, highlighting some notable points of variation with other Philippine-type languages along the way.

By way of introduction, consider the behavior of the pronouns *ka* and *nila* and the quotative adverb *daw* in (1) below. In the basic verb-initial clause in (1a), all of these items appear as a “cluster,” immediately following the verb. In its negative counterpart in (1b), however, all of these items obligatorily follow the clause-initial negator *hindi* instead.²

(1) Second-position placement of Tagalog clitics:

- a. Bi~bigy-an **ka** **daw nila** ng regalo.

FUT~give-LV 2SG.NOM QUOT 3PL.GEN GEN gift

‘Reportedly, they will give you a gift.’

- b. Hindi **ka** **daw nila** bi~bigy-an ng regalo.

NEG 2SG.NOM QUOT 3PL.GEN FUT~give-LV GEN gift

‘Reportedly, they will not give you a gift.’

Note that, in this chapter, we follow standard Tagalog/Filipino orthography, whereby second-position clitics are written as separate words. We reserve = for clitics that are conventionally written with its host as one word.

Clitics that exhibit the basic second-position placement behavior as exemplified in (1) are widely attested across languages of the Philippines. In fact, Himmelmann (2005) proposes the existence of such second-position clitics as one of the defining criteria for so-called Philippine-type languages,³ which comprise the languages of the Philippines, most of Taiwan, northern Borneo and Sulawesi, and Madagascar. In this chapter, we will concentrate on the detailed behavior of second-position clitics in Tagalog, with some reference throughout to related facts in other Philippine-type languages. Note that these languages also have other morphemes that constitute (simple) clitics, such as the prenominal case-marking articles (e.g. genitive *ng* intro-

¹ Some works refer to the clitic adverbs as “(discourse) particles”; see e.g. Schachter 1973; Schachter and Otanes 1972; Zorc 1974; Billings and Konopasky 2002.

² Glosses follow the abbreviations listed in the Leipzig Glossing Rules, with the following additions: AV: Actor Voice, CV: Conveyance/Circumstantial Voice, EMPH: emphatic, LK: linker, LV: Locative Voice, MIR: mirative, NVOL: nonvolitional form, POL: politeness, PV: Patient Voice.

³ For Himmelmann (2005: 113), other Philippine-type criteria include the existence of two or more undergoer voices (non-actor voices) and case-marking articles. However, other scholars, such as Blust (2010: 306), describe the presence of multiple undergoer voices as the sole criterion for Philippine-type classification. See discussion around example (15) for illustration of these properties in Tagalog. Proto-Austronesian has also been hypothesized to have had a Philippine-type grammar, including the existence of second-position clitic pronouns; see e.g. Wolff, 1996 and Ross 2002, especially p. 35.

ducing ‘gift’ in (1)).⁴ However, in this chapter we concentrate solely on their second-position clitics (or simply, “clitics”), such as the bolded items whose behavior we have highlighted in (1) above.

As with second-position clitics in various other languages, Philippine-type clitics raise a number of theoretical questions about the mapping between surface word order and hierarchical structure. We will argue, with previous authors, that the linear placement of clitics in Tagalog is determined postsyntactically based on a combination of phonologically-motivated and conventionalized ordering restrictions, and do not directly reflect their logical syntactic positions. At the same time, aspects of the behaviors and inventories of second-position clitics reflect and elucidate the underlying syntactic structure of the Tagalog clause as well.

We begin in section 2 with a more detailed description of the clitics’ linear placement that leads to their description as second-position clitics. In section 3, we present the inventory of second-position clitics, highlighting a generalization regarding the inventory of clitic pronouns and challenges related to the flexible placement of adverbs. Finally, in section 4, we discuss the ordering of multiple clitics and the semantic scope-taking of adverbial clitics, emphasizing the extent of mismatches between the linear and structural positions of clitics.

2 Second-position clitic placement

We first elaborate on the description of the second position nature of these clitics in Tagalog. Tagalog and other Philippine-type languages are strongly predicate-initial. In basic sentences, the lexical predicate of the clause appears clause-initially, while case-marked arguments follow the predicate. Thus, in verbally predicated clauses, such as (1a), the verb appears clause-initially and second-position clitics follow the verb. Clauses with nominal and adjectival predicates exhibit parallel behavior.

The appearance of various heads or phrases before the lexical predicate leads to displacement of the clitics, so that the clitics then immediately follow the clause-initial head or phrase. We have already seen in (1) above that negation serves as a “host” for second-position clitics, triggering their placement immediately following itself. Examples (2b,c) show that a focus-fronted adverbial or PP (in square brackets) also serves as a host for clitic placement, obligatorily shifting the linear position for the clitics *ko* and *nga* relative to the baseline in (2a). Within the cluster of clitics, the relative order (e.g., between *ko* and *nga*) remains constant (see section 4.1 below).

⁴ Phrase-marking clitics in some Philippine languages have received broader theoretical attention for being ditropic: in particular, syntactically proclitic but phonologically enclitic. See especially discussion in Himmelmann 2014.

(2) **Clitics hosted by focus-fronted adjuncts in preverbal position:**

- a. I-ha~halo **ko nga** sa sabaw ang asin mamaya.
 CV-FUT~mix 1SG.GEN EMPH OBL soup NOM salt later
 ‘I will indeed mix the salt into the soup later.’
- b. [Mamaya] { **ko nga** } i-ha~halo { ***ko nga** } sa sabaw ang asin.
 later 1SG.GEN EMPH CV-FUT~mix OBL soup NOM salt
 ‘It’s indeed [later]_F that I will mix the salt into the soup.’
- c. [Sa sabaw] { **ko nga** } i-ha~halo { ***ko nga** } ang asin mamaya.
 OBL soup 1SG.GEN EMPH CV-FUT~mix NOM salt later
 ‘It’s indeed [in the soup]_F that I will mix the salt later.’

Other preverbal expressions that serve as hosts for second-position clitic placement include *wh*-adjuncts, manner adverbs, and preverbal agent pronouns in a construction known as genitive inversion (Hsieh, 2023).

Where more than one potential host precedes the predicate, the clitics must follow the higher host. Consider the examples in (3) below, where a focus-fronted PP appears above or below negation, with an interpretational difference. In either case, the clitics must immediately follow whichever is the structurally higher host.⁵

(3) **Clitics follow the higher of multiple preverbal hosts:**

- a. [Hindi] { **ko nga** } [sa sabaw] { ***ko nga** } i-ha~halo ang asin mamaya.
 NEG 1SG.GEN EMPH OBL soup CV-FUT~mix NOM salt later
 ‘It’s indeed not in the soup that I will mix the salt later.’
- b. [Sa sabaw] { **ko nga** } [hindi] { ***ko nga** } i-ha~halo ang asin mamaya.
 OBL soup 1SG.GEN EMPH NEG CV-FUT~mix NOM salt later
 ‘It’s indeed in the soup that I will not mix the salt later.’

However, not all preverbal material serves as a host for clitic placement. Complementizers do not serve as hosts in Tagalog, as illustrated with the conditional complementizer *kung* in (4).⁶

(4) **Complementizers do not host clitics:**

- Kung { ***pa pala kayo** } hindi { **pa pala kayo** } matu~tulog, ...
 if NEG still MIR 2PL.NOM AV.FUT~sleep
 ‘If you aren’t going to sleep yet after all, ...’

⁵ Optionality in placement has been reported where there are two potential hosts in Tagalog, one of which is *kailan* ‘when’ (Billings and Kaufman, 2004: 21) or *bakit* ‘why’ (Lee and Billings, 2005: 242; see also Kaufman 2010b: 189 note 5). More general flexibility in clitic placement in the presence of multiple potential preverbal hosts has been described for Masbatenyo (Lee, 2008: 128–129) and Pangasinan (Erlewine, Lim, and Branan, 2022: 170).

⁶ Kaufman (2010b: 11) suggests that the complementizers *kung* (as in (4)) and *na* do not host clitics because “mono-syllabic function words cannot host clitics in Tagalog.” However, this explanation is insufficient, as for example the reduced *di* and *ba’t* forms of the negator *hindi* and *bakit* ‘why’ can also host clitics.

Certain complementizers may serve as hosts in some Philippine languages such as Maranao (Kaufman, 2010a: 137), Masbatenyo (Lee, 2008: 128–129), and Tausug (Lee and Billings, 2005: 243), as well as in the Sama-Bajaw language Mapun (Billings and Kaufman 2004: 19–20, Lee and Billings 2005: 251).

Kroeger (1991: 135; 1993: 136–7) proposes that second-position clitics are placed after the first head or phrase within a particular domain, which we will refer to as the “clitic domain,” as we paraphrase in (5) below.

(5) **Generalization on clitic placement:**

Second-position clitics follow the first (or highest) overt head or phrase of the *clitic domain* that they belong to.

An important question is then what defines a clitic domain. Synthesizing the observations and proposals of Kaufman (2010b: 184ff) and Hsieh (2020: ch. 7) — both building on the approach to the description of the clause periphery pioneered in Rizzi 1997 — we propose the following hierarchy of projections that are optionally projected in the Tagalog clausal spine in (6). As illustrated in examples above, most clitics belong to a clitic domain that includes the position for preverbal focus and higher and lower negation, but not the complementizer (Force). Note that here we set aside topics, as their effects on clitic placement are more complex, but discuss such interactions at the end of this section.

(6) **The clitic domain of Tagalog clauses without topics (see also 13):**

$$\text{ForceP} > \underbrace{\left(\dots \text{NegP} > \text{FocP} > \text{NegP} > \text{IP} \right)}_{\text{clitic domain}}$$

As we might expect from the generalizations stated in (5–6), clitics cannot climb out of some types of embedded clauses, as exemplified in (7). These examples exhibit two distinct clitic domains; the bolded clitics here are pronominal arguments of the embedded clause and hence must remain in the embedded domain, while clitics originating in the matrix clause (e.g., *nila* 3PL.GEN in (7b)) are placed relative to their own domain.

(7) **Embedded clauses that disallow clitic climbing:**

a. Relative clauses:

S<in>abi { ***nila ako** } ni Maria[=ng sa~salubung-in { **nila ako** } dito].
 <PFV>say[PV] GEN Maria =LK FUT~meet-PV 3PL.GEN 1SG.NOM here
 ‘Maria said [that they would meet me here].’

b. Object control clause: (based on Kroeger, 1991: 144)

<In>utus-an nila { ***ako** } si Maria[=ng salubung-in { **ako** } dito].
 <PFV>order-LV 3PL.GEN NOM Maria =LK meet-PV 1SG.NOM here
 ‘I ordered Maria [to meet them here].’

However, some structures with embedded clauses constitute only one clitic domain, thereby exhibiting “restructuring.” In example (8a), the pronoun *ako* is an argument of the embedded verb ‘meet,’ but must be placed in second-position relative to the matrix clause. Example (8b) illustrates a case of optional clitic climbing with an initial adverbial.

(8) **Clitic climbing out of a restructuring embeddings:**

- a. Subject control clause:

Gusto { **ako** } ni Maria [=ng salubung-in { ***ako** } dito].

want 1SG.NOM GEN Maria =LK meet-PV here

'Maria wants [to meet me here].'

- b. Initial adverbial predicate:

Madalas { **ko** } [=ng nari~rinig { **ko** } iyon].

often 1SG.GEN =LK NVOL.IPFV~hear[PV] NOM.DIST

'I've often heard that.'

(Schachter and Otones, 1972: 193)

Similar behavior is observed in DP focus constructions. Whereas clitics must follow focused PPs when they are the highest potential host (cf. (2b), (3b)), clitics that are logically associated with the backgrounded material in a DP-focus construction cannot follow the focused DP. The examples in (9) shows that clitic adverbs may either follow the focused DP or appear within the backgrounded material, with a difference in interpretation, whereas pronominal clitics must stay in the lower clitic domain (10).

(9) **Two clitic domains in DP focus constructions:**

- a. [Ang asin] **na** ang [i-ha~halo ko sa sabaw].

NOM salt now NOM CV-FUT~mix 1SG.GEN OBL soup

'It's now the salt that I will mix into the soup.'

(I was going to add a different seasoning but I changed my mind)

- b. [Ang asin] ang [i-ha~halo ko **na** sa sabaw].

NOM salt NOM CV-FUT~mix 1SG.GEN now OBL soup

'It's the salt that I will now mix into the soup.'

(10) **Pronominal clitics must stay in the lower domain:**

[Ang asin] { ***ko** } ang [i-ha~halo { **ko** } sa sabaw].

NOM salt NOM CV-FUT~mix 1SG.GEN OBL soup

'It's the salt that I will mix into the soup.'

These clitic placement facts have been taken to show that DP focus constructions are biclausal (Kroeger, 1991: 210, 1993: 212–213; Richards, 1998; Aldridge, 2002; Mercado, 2004; Hsieh, 2020, i.e. pseudoclefts, with the focused DP serving as the matrix predicate and taking a headless relative clause as its subject. On this view, these constructions are structurally more similar to the embedded clause examples in (7) with two clitic domains than with the PP focus constructions as in (2).

Finally, we address clitic placement in clauses with topics, which are followed by a pause or topic marker *ay*. In clauses with topics, some adverbial clitics follow the topic (but precede the *ay* marker) whereas others follow the highest non-topic host. For instance, consider the position of the question marker *ba* in (11a) versus *pa* 'still' in (11b) below.

(11) **Adverbial clitics vary in their placement with respect to topics:**

- a. [Ang sabaw] { **ba** } ay ni-lagy-an { * **ba** } niya ng hipon?
 NOM soup Q TOP PFV-put-LV 3SG.GEN GEN shrimp
 ‘As for the soup, did he/she put shrimp in it?’
- b. [Ang sabaw] { * **pa** } ay ni-lagy-an { **pa** } niya ng hipon.
 NOM soup TOP PFV-put-LV still 3SG.GEN GEN shrimp
 ‘Into the soup, he/she still/even put shrimp.’

Some adverbial clitics may follow the topic or the next highest host, with a difference in interpretation. For example, the additive focus particle *din* must associate with the topic in (12a) whereas it associates with some other part of the description in (12b).

(12) **Some adverbial clitics allow both positions, with difference in interpretation:**

(based on Schachter and Otones, 1972: 430)

- a. [Bukas] **din** ay sa~sayaw sila ng pandango.
 tomorrow also TOP FUT~dance[AV] 3PL.NOM GEN fandango
 ‘They will also dance a fandango [tomorrow]_F.’
- b. [Bukas] ay sa~sayaw **din** sila ng pandango.
 tomorrow TOP FUT~dance[AV] also 3PL.NOM GEN fandango
 ‘Tomorrow, they will also dance [a fandango]_F.’ (other focus options also available)

In contrast, pronominal clitics uniformly resist taking topics as their host, and so must be placed on the next highest potential host in the clause. The underlined pronominal clitics in (11–12) cannot be placed in any other position.

These facts suggest that when a topic projection (TopP) is projected, it introduces a clitic domain boundary, as reflected in (13) below. In line with Kroeger’s descriptive generalization in (5) above, individual clitics will then be linearized in the clitic domain that they belong to.

(13) **Clitic domains in Tagalog clauses with topics:** (cf. 6)

(based on Kaufman 2010b: 185, revised in Hsieh 2020: ch. 7)

$$\text{ForceP} > \left(\dots \text{TopP}^* > \left(\begin{array}{c} \text{NegP} > \text{FocP} > \text{NegP} > \text{IP} \\ \text{clitic domain} \end{array} \right) \right)$$

This description accurately predicts that clitic adverbs that must follow topics are logically associated with the higher clause periphery, such as the question marker *ba* in (11a) above. In contrast, pronominal clitics are never linearized immediately following topics because they logically reflect argument positions within IP (see also sec. 3.1) and hence belong to the lower clitic domain in clauses with topics. In simple clauses without topics, however, there is only one clitic domain and hence all clitics form a cluster together; for instance, example (14) in the next section shows the question marker *ba* and *pa* ‘still’ forming a cluster in a topic-less clause, even though they cannot form a cluster when there is a topic as in (11). See also Schachter

and Otnes 1972: 429–435, McFarland 2001, and Kaufman 2010b for additional clitic adverb placement facts.

With this overview of the general nature of second-position placement in Tagalog in place, we now turn to the inventory of items that exhibit this behavior.

3 The inventory of second-position clitics

As we have seen in the examples so far, the second-position clitics in Tagalog consist of pronouns and adverbs. We present a basic inventory here and discuss various details about their behavior. The clitic pronouns consist of nominative and genitive case forms of animate pronouns, as well as a portmanteau pronoun *kita*, listed in Table 1. We introduce relevant case facts and discuss this inventory further in section 3.1 below. On the other hand, the clitic adverbs are relatively diverse, ranging over a number of semantic functions. These are listed with approximate glosses in Table 2. We will discuss the inventory of clitic adverbs further in section 3.2.

Table 1: Tagalog pronominal clitics

	1SG	2SG	3SG	1PL.EXCL	1PL.INCL	2PL	3PL
NOM	<i>ako</i>	<i>ka</i>	<i>siya</i>	<i>kami</i>	<i>tayo</i>	<i>kayo</i>	<i>silá</i>
GEN	<i>ko</i>	<i>mo</i>	<i>niya</i>	<i>namin</i>	<i>natin</i>	<i>ninyo</i>	<i>nila</i>
1SG.GEN > 2SG.NOM <i>kita</i>							

Table 2: Tagalog adverbial clitics

(based on Schachter and Otnes, 1972; McFarland, 2001; Kaufman, 2010b)

TEMPORAL	FOCUS	EPISTEMIC STANCE
<i>agad</i> ‘immediately’	<i>din</i> ‘also’	<i>daw</i> reported speech
<i>muna</i> ‘first’	<i>lang/lamang</i> ‘only’	<i>kaya</i> speculative
<i>na</i> ‘already / now’	<i>man</i> ‘even’	<i>pala</i> mirative
<i>pa</i> ‘still’		<i>siguro</i> ‘probably’
<i>uli</i> ‘again’		<i>talaga</i> ‘really / very’
		<i>yata</i> ‘perhaps’
DISCOURSE	SPEECH ACT	
<i>kasi</i> ‘because’	<i>ba</i> question marker	
<i>naman</i> switch topic	<i>nawa</i> hortative	
<i>nga</i> ‘indeed’	<i>po/ho</i> politeness	
<i>tuloy</i> ‘as a result’	<i>sana</i> hortative, optative, counterfactual	

There are some minor differences between pronominal versus adverbial clitics, for instance in the possibility of “interrupting” hosts: adverbial clitics have the option of appearing in second-position *within* certain types of phrasal hosts, but pronominal clitics never can (Schachter and Otnes, 1972: 433–5; Kaufman, 2010b). For example, (14a) shows that the

adverbial clitics *pa* and *ba* have two possible positions, whereas any other placement of the pronominal *kayo* is ungrammatical. Example (14b) illustrates the same for the case of adverbial clitics that can be hosted by a topic, as in (11b) above.

(14) **Adverbial clitics can optionally appear inside phrasal hosts, but pronominal clitics cannot:**

- a. [Saan { **pa ba** } =ng panadero] { **pa ba** } kayo b<um>i~bili ng tinapay?
 where still Q =LK baker 2PL.NOM AV.IPFV~buy GEN bread
 ‘From which other baker will you buy bread?’ (based on Kaufman, 2010b: 12; ex. 20)
- b. [Bukas {**ba**} ng gabi] { **ba** } ay sa~sayaw sila ng pandango?
 tomorrow Q GEN night TOP FUT~dance[AV] 3PL.NOM GEN fandango
 ‘Tomorrow night, will they dance a fandango?’ (Schachter and Otones, 1972: 429–430)

Other processes also distinguish pronominal and adverbial clitics. For example, the ordering of clitics within a cluster makes reference to these classes (sec. 4.1), and various forms of ellipsis targeting the VP must also delete associated pronominal clitics but not adverbial clitics (see Kaufman 2010b: 244–250, building on Richards 2003).

3.1 Clitic pronouns

In this section, we discuss the range of nominal arguments and forms that can serve as second-position clitics. As we will see, second-position clitic status is only possible for certain clausal arguments and for certain types of nominals — that is, based on both the nominal’s status within the clause and its own structure — with neither criterion reducible to the other.

To better ground this discussion, we first briefly introduce the logic of nominal case-marking and voice morphology in Philippine-type languages, also often called the “voice system” (see also Erlewine, Levin, and Van Urk, 2017; Chen and McDonnell, 2019). In these languages, one argument in each clause (the “pivot”) has a privileged status, bearing nominative case and being the sole possible target for $\bar{A}$ -movement. Voice morphology on the verb then cross-references the choice of pivot argument. There are also voices that identify certain oblique arguments as the pivot. Other, non-pivot arguments may be introduced by genitive or oblique case-markers or prepositions.⁷

(15) **Voice alternation:** (Hsieh, 2020: 1 ex. 1)

- a. Nagsu~sulat ang estudyante ng tula sa folder.
 AV.IPFV~write NOM student GEN poem OBL folder
 ‘The student is writing a poem on the folder.’

⁷ Genitive case is so called because it is also the case of nominal possessors. Note that there is an alternative tradition where the clausal arguments we describe as nominative and genitive here have been analyzed as absolutive and ergative, respectively. See Erlewine, Levin, and Van Urk 2017 and Kaufman 2017b for critical discussion.

See Hsieh 2020, to appear, Erlewine and Lim 2023, and Chen to appear for some recent analyses of these voice systems.

- b. S<in>u~sulat ng estudyante ang tula sa folder.
 IPFV~write[PV] GEN student NOM poem OBL folder
 ‘The/A student is writing the poem on the folder.’
- c. S<in>u~sulat-an ng estudyante ng tula ang folder.
 IPFV~write-LV GEN student GEN poem NOM folder
 ‘The/A student is writing a poem on the folder.’

The animate clitic pronouns in Table 1 all show the second-position placement behavior discussed in section 2, so we can clearly classify them as Tagalog second-position clitics. They cannot appear freely in the postverbal field as non-pronominal noun phrase arguments can; see (16).⁸

(16) **Animate pronouns with clitic forms must be clitics:**

Hindi { **ka** **nila** } bi~bigy-an { ***ka nila** } ng regalo.
 NEG 2SG.NOM 3PL.GEN FUT~give-LV GEN gift
 ‘They will not give you a gift.’

In contrast, demonstrative pronouns (used generally for all inanimate referents) may exhibit “optional clisis,” appearing either in the second-position clitic position or a regular postverbal argument position, as illustrated in example (18a) below. Clitic-like placement is also possible for proper names, for at least some speakers; see Billings 2005: 316–321 and citations there.

We note that the set of animate clitic pronouns in Table 1 above comes in only two case variants: nominative and genitive. This can be understood as a corollary of a broader generalization regarding which arguments allow for clitic pronouns and which do not, which has been well known amongst Austronesianists but first articulated by Erlewine and Levin (2021) (E&L):

(17) **Generalization:** (Erlewine and Levin, 2021: 412)

In transitive clauses, second position clitic pronouns in Philippine-type languages are limited to pivot arguments and non-pivot agents.

E&L shows that this generalization holds across the broad range of so-called Philippine-type Austronesian languages (see note 3). This includes many languages of the Philippines (including Tagalog) and Taiwan which have exactly two series of clitic pronouns with pivots in nominative case and non-pivot agents in genitive case, as well as languages such as Malagasy which only have clitic pronouns for non-pivot agents.

⁸ There are also free (non-clitic) nominative pronouns, all of which are homophonous with the clitic forms with the exception of the second person singular (clitic *ka* versus free form *ikaw*). These free forms are used when the pronoun appears in isolation or as a predicate nominal or focus, as in the DP focus construction in (i).

(i) { Ikaw / *Ka } ang nag-luto ng pagkain.
 2SG.NOM(free) 2SG.NOM(clitic) NOM AV.PFV-COOK GEN food
 ‘It was you who cooked food.’

E&L argue that this generalization cannot be reduced to a matter of case: that is, it is insufficient to say that clitic pronouns only come in nominative and genitive forms. Recall from (15) above that non-pivot agents and non-pivot themes can both be genitive case. Now consider the examples below, which involve the genitive proximate demonstrative *nito* ‘this.’ In example (18a), *nito* as the non-pivot agent of a Patient Voice clause exhibits optional clisis and so may follow the preverbal host *hindi* or be in the postverbal field. However, in (18b) where *nito* is a non-pivot theme of an Actor Voice clause, there is no clitic pronoun option.

(18) **Lack of non-pivot theme clitic pronouns cannot be a matter of case:**

(Erlewine and Levin, 2021: 411–412)

- a. Ang lalaki ang hindi { **nito** } na-kita { **nito** } .

NOM boy NOM NEG GEN.PROX PV.PFV-see

‘It’s the boy that this one didn’t see.’

- b. Ang lalaki ang hindi { ***nito** } naka-kita { **nito** } .

NOM boy NOM NEG AV.PFV-see GEN.PROX

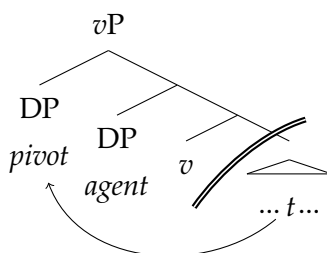
‘It’s the boy who didn’t see this one.’

As E&L note, this paradigm constitutes a poverty-of-the-stimulus argument for the need for a deeper explanation for the generalization in (17). A learner may encounter positive evidence for the optional clisis of the proximal demonstrative *nito* as in (18a), but there is no negative evidence that the clitic option is unavailable for the same form when used as a non-pivot theme instead. Absent the generalization in (17), we may expect learners to incorrectly generalize the optional clisis of the demonstrative to extend to non-pivot themes as in (18b) as well.

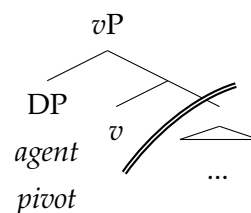
E&L offer an explanation for the generalization (17) based on the notion of the phase. Many phase-based accounts for Philippine-type voice systems (see e.g. Aldridge, 2004, 2008; Rackowski and Richards, 2005; Erlewine and Lim, 2023) have independently proposed that the pivot in a Non-Actor Voice clause moves to an outer specifier of the phase head, making the external argument (agent) its inner specifier (19a), whereas no such movement takes place in an Actor Voice clause (19b). Material below the double line is assumed to be inaccessible for higher syntactic operations (Chomsky, 2001).

(19) **The organization of the verbal phase, to explain (17):**

- a. Non-Actor Voices:



- b. Actor Voice:



Assuming that the derivation of clitic pronouns requires a syntactic dependency that is sensitive to this phase boundary such as movement, E&L observe that pivots and non-pivot agents are

precisely the only arguments that should allow for clitic pronouns. The organization of the verbal phase in Philippine-type languages, then, serves to derive the generalization in (17) above. See also Hsieh to appear for another account that shares the intuition that the pivot and the non-pivot agent may uniquely be accessible to the higher phase, but with a different structural proposal.

Finally, we note the attestation of certain complex nominals, (left-)headed by a clitic pronoun, being linearized as if they are a clitic pronoun. Notable examples include conjunctions of a clitic pronoun and another nominal (20a), inclusory pronoun constructions (20b) (see also Reid, 2009), and modified pronouns (20c). Kaufman (2010b, 2017a) describes these expressions as being “coerced” into clitic position, and notes that “although examples may be found relatively easily in casual written texts, speakers may hesitate in accepting them as fully grammatical” (2010b: 26). Even with their marginal status, however, the attestation of such forms for at least some speakers clearly distinguishes Tagalog clitic pronouns from clitic pronouns in various other language families, which resist any form of conjunction or modification (see e.g. Kayne, 1975; Cardinaletti and Starke, 1999).

(20) **Certain nominal phrases can be “coerced” into clitic positions:**

(Kaufman, 2010b: 90–91)

- a. Conjunction with clitic pronoun as left conjunct:

Hindi [ako at si Juan] da~rating.
 NEG 1SG.NOM and NOM Juan FUT~arrive[AV]
 ‘Juan and I won’t arrive.’

- b. Inclusory pronoun construction:

Hindi [kami ng pamilya ko] da~rating.
 NEG 1PL.EXCL.NOM GEN family 1SG.GEN FUT~arrive[AV]
 ‘We (which includes my family) won’t arrive.’

- c. Modified pronoun:

Hindi [sila =ng lima] da~rating.
 NEG 3PL.NOM =LK five FUT~arrive[AV]
 ‘They five won’t arrive.’

3.2 Clitic adverbs

The inventory of adverbial clitics in Tagalog is somewhat more difficult to identify conclusively, as adverbs in general are more flexible in terms of their word order, with some appearing to conform to the second-position placement behavior discussed in section 2 while also being able to appear in other positions. This variation in placement behavior falls on a spectrum from clear second-position clitics to clear non-clitics.

A number of adverbs are obligatorily second-position clitics: they must occur in the second-position slot as described in section 2. Among the items in Table 2, all the monosyllabic adverbs as well as *muna* ‘first’, switch topic *naman*, mirative *pala*, *yata* ‘perhaps’ are obligatory clitics (McFarland, 2001: 2). In predicate-initial clauses, these adverbs must immediately follow the predicate; however, in the presence of any preverbal clitic hosts, they must immediately follow the highest such host. We observe this behavior with the adverbs *na*, *daw*, and *pala* in (21) below, where the placement of any one of them in positions marked { * } will lead to ungrammaticality. See also (3) which showed this behavior for the emphatic particle *nga*.

(21) **Adverbs showing obligatory second-position placement:**

- a. Matu~talog { **na** **daw** **pala** } ang bisita { * } sa sofa { * }.
 AV.FUT~sleep now QUOT MIR NOM guest OBL couch
 ≈ ‘Turns out, as I was told, the guest will now sleep on the couch.’
- b. [Sa sofa] { **na** **daw** **pala** } matu~talog { * } ang bisita { * }.
 OBL couch now QUOT MIR AV.FUT~sleep NOM guest
 ≈ ‘Turns out, as I was told, the guest will now sleep [on the couch]_F.’
- c. [Hindi] { **na** **daw** **pala** } [sa sofa] { * } matu~talog { * } ang bisita { * }.
 NEG now QUOT MIR OBL couch AV.FUT~sleep NOM guest
 ≈ ‘Turns out, as I was told, the guest will no longer sleep [on the couch]_F.’

Moving beyond these adverbs which are unambiguously second-position clitics, various other adverbs exhibit a more ambiguous behavior. First, there are a few expressions that may appear either clause-initially or else display second-position placement behavior. An example of this is *kasi* ‘because’, as in (22a). Here, *kasi* may appear either before or after the verb when there are no preverbal clitic hosts. When a preverbal host is present, such as negation in (22b), we observe the typical second-position behavior (i.e., the clitic must follow the preverbal host, rather than the verb) in addition to the clause-initial placement option seen in (22a). The behavior of *kasi* contrasts with the clitic pronoun *ako* in (22), which only shows second-position behavior.⁹

(22) **Clause-initial and second-position alternation:**

- a. { **Kasi** } magla~laro { **kasi** } ako ng basketbol { * } bukas { * }.
 because AV.FUT~play 1SG.NOM GEN basketball tomorrow
 ‘(It’s) Because I’m going to play basketball tomorrow.’
- b. { **Kasi** } hindi { **kasi** } ako magla~laro { * } ng basketbol { * } bukas { * }.
 because NEG 1SG.NOM AV.FUT~play GEN basketball tomorrow
 ‘(It’s) Because I’m not going to play basketball tomorrow.’

⁹ When some of the more flexible adverbs appear in clause-initial position, they do not serve as preverbal hosts for other clitics. For instance, *ako* stays in its indicated position even with clause-initial *kasi* in (22a,b). The same behavior is observed in examples (23) and (24) below, where the clause-initial placement of the bolded adverbs in question does not affect the position of the underlined clitics.

The hortative particles *nawa* and *sana* also exhibit clause-initial and second-position variants. See (23) below. Note also that some clause-initial forms of adverbs are formally distinguished from their second-position forms, for instance with clause-initial *nawa* in (23a) requiring the topic particle *ay*, which contracts to *y* after vowels. Clause-initial *sana* can also be followed by *ay*; see Kaufman 2006: 158.

(23) **Other adverbs with clause-initial and second-position uses:**

- a. { **Nawa**=*y* } huwag { **nawa** } ako=ng ma-pa-hiya { * }...
 hopefully=TOP PROH 1SG.NOM=LK NVOL-CAUS-shame[PV]
 ‘May I not be put to shame...’ (adapted from Psalm 31:17¹⁰)
- b. { **Sana** } ma-nalo rin { **sana** } ang kandidato ko { * }.
 hopefully AV-win also NOM candidate 1SG.GEN
 ‘Hopefully my candidate wins too.’ (adapted from Avelino, to appear: exx. 2a, 3a)

Finally, some adverbs show a much higher degree of flexibility, for instance *in* also appearing in various postverbal positions. Consider *talaga* ‘really’ in (24) below. In this example, the locative adjunct *dito* ‘here’ is focus-fronted, therefore serving as the host for second-position clitics including the underlined pronoun *ako*. *Talaga* can also appear in this clitic cluster together with *ako*. But we also see that *talaga* can appear quite freely in the postverbal field, as many non-clitic adverbs do (see e.g. Schachter and Otnes, 1972: 436ff).¹¹

(24) **Flexible placement of *talaga* ‘really’, including in clitic cluster:**

- a. [Dito] { **talaga** } ako { **talaga** } magla~laro { **talaga** } ng basketbol { **talaga** }.
 here really 1SG.NOM AV.FUT~play GEN basketball
 ‘I’m really going to play basketball [here]_F.’

This significant flexibility in the position of *talaga* raises the question of whether *talaga* in fact warrants its description as a potential second-position clitic. That is, could its apparent second-position behavior simply be a consequence of its more general, flexible placement? To answer this question, we can compare the behavior of *talaga* with other adverbs like *bukas* ‘tomorrow’. Example (25a) shows that *bukas* is almost as flexible as *talaga*, except that it crucially cannot appear with *ako* in the clitic cluster after *dito*. This supports the description of *talaga* as having both postverbal and second-position clitic uses, in addition to a clause-initial use.¹²

(25) **Flexible postverbal placement of *bukas* ‘tomorrow’, but not as a clitic:** (cf. 24)

- [Dito] { * } ako { * } magla~laro { **bukas** } ng basketbol { **bukas** }.
 here 1SG.NOM AV.FUT~play tomorrow GEN basketball
 ‘I’m going to play basketball [here]_F tomorrow.’

¹⁰ Attested with *huwag nawa* order in *Ang Dating Biblia*; see <https://www.biblegateway.com/passage/?search=Awit%2031%3A17-19&version=ADB1905>.

¹¹ Another adverb that shows this degree of flexibility is *uli(t)* ‘again’. See Kaufman 2006: 157 ex. 14 for some examples.

As we have seen, Tagalog adverbs show relatively heterogeneous behavior, so we cannot go into full detail here (even for the adverbs already discussed) for reasons of space. However, despite this heterogeneity, we have illustrated how one might distinguish between what is a second position clitic (perhaps amongst other uses) and what simply shows flexible word order.

In addition to their individual uses, some combinations of clitic adverbs together introduce semantic effects that appear, at least at first glance, to differ from what would be expected from the simple cooccurrence of its individual parts. We give a few such combinations here in (26), together with brief, approximate descriptions of their combined effects. See Hsieh and Erlewine to appear, in prep for further discussion and analysis of such combinations.

(26) **Some less semantically transparent clitic adverb combinations:**

- a. *pa* ‘still’ + *lang* ‘only’ $\rightsquigarrow$ low progress
- b. *na* ‘already’ + *lang* ‘only’ $\rightsquigarrow$ change of plan, ‘instead’
- c. *pa* ‘still’ + *rin* ‘also’ $\rightsquigarrow$ ‘still’ despite threat to plan
- d. *man* ‘even’ + *lang* ‘only’ $\rightsquigarrow$ negative polarity ‘even’
- e. *na* ‘already’ + *naman* switch topic $\rightsquigarrow$ ‘again’

There is also a growing body of work on the detailed semantics and pragmatics of individual clitic adverbs in Tagalog as well as their formal analysis. See AnderBois 2016 on the discourse management particle *naman*, AnderBois 2023 on the mirative *pala*, and Avelino to appear on the hortative/optative *sana*. Hsieh and Erlewine to appear offers a formal account for the semantics of *na* ‘already/now,’ *pa* ‘still,’ and *lang* ‘only,’ acknowledging their diverse uses. See also Richards 2019 for a description of association with focus possibilities with *lang/lamang* ‘only.’ Finally, we refer readers to Tanangkingsing 2013 for an overview of the functions of second-position clitic adverbs in Cebuano.

4 On the nature of clitic placement

We now conclude by further probing the nature of clitic placement. Descriptively second-position behavior could be derived as a result of particular but standard syntactic processes such as movement, or else could reflect a separate, postsyntactic rearrangement of morphemes. For Tagalog, there is evidence that motivates the latter view. We introduce two sets of facts

¹² In clause-initial position, *talaga* takes the linker =*ng*. See (i). Clause-initial *talaga* does not itself serve as a potential clitic host, like the clause-initial uses of *kasi*, *nawa*, and *sana* in (22–23) above.

(i) *Talaga=ng magla~laro ako ng basketbol.*
 really=LK AV.FUT~play 1SG.NOM GEN basketball
 ‘I’m really going to play basketball.’

In contrast, when *bukas* ‘tomorrow’ is in clause-initial position via focus-fronting, it itself serves as a host for clitics:

(ii) *Bukas { ako } magla~laro { *ako } ng basketbol.*
 tomorrow 1SG.NOM AV.FUT~play GEN basketball
 ‘It’s tomorrow that I’m going to play basketball.’

that point in this direction: the cluster-internal ordering of clitics, which makes reference to phonological weight, and evidence from the semantic scope of adverbial clitics.

4.1 Cluster-internal order

As seen above, where a clitic domain includes multiple clitics, they will cluster together. The order of clitics within a cluster presents the first argument for the need for the postsyntactic arrangement of clitics.

In Tagalog, the linear order of clitics that cooccur in a cluster is mostly fixed, based on their type (pronoun vs adverbial) and phonological size (mono- vs multisyllabic), as schematized in (27). The ordering of pronominal clitics by phonological weight is also attested across other Central Philippine languages (Billings and Konopasky, 2002; Lee, 2004).

(27) The order of Tagalog second-position clitics:

$$1\sigma \text{ pronouns} < 1\sigma \text{ adverbs} < 2+\sigma \text{ adverbs} < 2\sigma \text{ pronouns}$$

We see a concrete illustration of this ordering in (29), which shows that the monosyllabic clitic adverb *lang* must precede the disyllabic pronominal clitic *ako* (1SG.NOM) in (28a) but follow the monosyllabic pronominal clitic *ka* (2SG.NOM) in (28b). That phonological weight is a factor can also be clearly seen with *ninyo* (2PL.GEN), which is disyllabic, but has a monosyllabic contracted form *n'yo*. Disyllabic *ninyo* must follow *lang* as in (28a), but monosyllabic *n'yo* must precede it, as in (28b).¹³

(28) **Monosyllabic pronouns before adverbs, followed by multisyllabic pronouns:**

- a. Ini~inom **lang {nila / ninyo }** ang tsaa. * ... **{nila/ninyo} lang** ...
 IPFV~drink[PV] only 3PL.GEN 2PL.GEN NOM tea
 ‘{They/You}’re only drinking the tea.’
- b. Ini~inom **{ko / n’yo }** **lang** ang tsaa. * ... **lang {ko/n’yo }** ...
 IPFV~drink[PV] 1SG.GEN 2PL.GEN only NOM tea
 ‘{I’m/You’re} only drinking the tea.’

As per the generalization in (17) above, in Non-Actor Voice clauses, two clitic pronouns — the non-pivot agent in genitive and the pivot in nominative — can cooccur. Where two disyllabic pronouns cooccur, there is a strong preference for the genitive to precede the nominative, as in (29) (see e.g. Schachter and Otnes 1972: 184–6; McFarland 2001). The effects of this preference are also observed across various Philippine languages (see e.g. Reid and Liao 2004: 443, Billings and Kaufman 2004, as well as discussion in Riesberg et al. 2019: 541–544); in fact, genitive before nominative is reported to be the sole determinant of clitic pronoun order in languages of the Central Luzon subgroup (Billings and Kaufman, 2004: 16–17) as well as in Tausug and

¹³ Billings (2005: 312) reports *n'yo* preceding adverbial clitics as marked, with one question mark, but this order is completely unmarked in the first author's experience and has been corroborated with other native speakers. He also discusses the behavior of *niya* / *n'ya* (3SG.GEN), which appears to show variable ordering behavior.

(29) Genitive precedes nominative amongst pronouns of equal size:

- The order of clitic adverbs within the monosyllabic adverb and multisyllabic adverb domains of (27) is also largely conventionally determined, as per (30) below from Kaufman 2006, 2010b. Commas separate items that are in complementary distribution and *din* and *lang* are claimed to be interchangeable (see also 33 below). This ordering should be understood as the unmarked order; Schachter and Otnes (1972: 413–5) describe the variation in adverbial ordering while McFarland’s (2001) corpus study quantifies this variation.

- a. 1σ adverbs:
- | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | |
|------------|-----------|---|-----------------|---|------------|---|------------|---|------------|---|-------------|---|-------------|---|--------------|---|-----------|
| <i>na,</i> | <i>pa</i> | > | <i>na naman</i> | > | <i>man</i> | > | <i>nga</i> | > | <i>din</i> | ~ | <i>lang</i> | > | <i>datw</i> | > | <i>po/ho</i> | > | <i>ba</i> |
| already | still | | again | | even | | EMPH | | also | | only | | QUOT | | POL | | Q |
- b. $2+\sigma$ adverbs:
- | | | | | | | |
|--------------|---|--------------|--------------|-------------|---|-------------|
| <i>naman</i> | > | <i>yata,</i> | <i>pala,</i> | <i>sana</i> | > | <i>kaya</i> |
| switch topic | | perhaps | mirative | hortative | | speculative |

¹⁴ Person hierarchies also play a role in clitic pronoun ordering in some Philippine-type languages. See for example Hung and Billings 2009 on languages of Mindanao (southern Philippines) and Holmer and Billings 2014 and Jiang and Billings 2015 on some Formosan languages.

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to be closer to the host, but requiring later phonological reordering to ultimately satisfy (27). To evaluate this shared intuition that structurally lower adverbial clitics precede structurally higher ones, we more explicitly consider semantic scope in the next section and show that the scope relationships between adverbial clitics do not map neatly to their surface order.

4.2 Adverbial clitics and semantic scope

To better understand the nature of the relationship between the linear placement of clitics and their associated structural positions, Kaufman (2006: 178–179) and Hsieh and Erlewine (2023) advocate for the consideration of the semantic scope of adverbial clitics. That is, for adverbial clitics with clear semantic effects that take scope over a particular portion of the clause, we can use this behavior as evidence for their true, logical structural positions. In this section, we present one such case study which strengthens the conclusion that the linear position of clitics does *not* reliably reflect their structural positions.

The examples we will discuss here involve the clitics *din* ‘also’ and *lang* ‘only’. The semantic contributions of both clitics parallel that of their well-studied counterparts in English and other languages, as illustrated and formalized in Hsieh and Erlewine 2023, to appear. Both make semantic contributions that are sensitive to the position of focus on the sentence. Formally, following Rooth 1985, 1992 and much subsequent work, focus-sensitive expressions make reference to the stated proposition in its scope (the prejacent) as well as a set of contextually determined alternative propositions, which vary with respect to the value of the focused position. In brief, *din* ‘also’ presupposes the truth of one such alternative proposition and asserts the truth of the prejacent, whereas *lang* ‘only’ presupposes the truth of the prejacent and asserts that the other alternative propositions are false.

Consider the two mini-discourses presented in English in (31) below. Each contain two sentences, with the second involving both *only* and *also*. Both discourses are natural in English, and the intended associations between *only/also* and their foci are indicated with lines underneath. Notably, discourse A requires *also* to scope over *only* (for the additive presupposition to itself be about an ‘only’ claim) whereas discourse B requires *only* to scope over *also*.

(31) **Two discourses with *only* and *also*:**

- A. John speaks only [English]_F. [Mary_F] also speaks only [English]_F.
- B. Everyone here speaks Tagalog. Only [Mary]_F also speaks [English]_F.

Now consider the two examples in (32), which are felicitous Tagalog renderings for the second sentences in each of discourses A and B above. Both of these examples involve two clitic domains, allowing for the clear separation of *din* and *lang*: (32a) has a topic (see (11–13)) whereas (32b) is a DP focus construction (see (9–10)). As expected based on their surface structures, *din* ‘also’ associating with Mary takes scope over *lang* ‘only’ associating with the

predicate ‘speak English’ in (32a), making it appropriate as the second sentence in discourse A but not B, whereas *lang* ‘only’ associating with Mary takes scope over *din* ‘also’ associating with ‘speak English’ in (32b), making it appropriate in discourse B but not A.

(32) **Two examples with separated *din* ‘also’ and *lang* ‘only’:**

- a. Si Mary **din** ay nag-i~English **lang**.
 NOM Mary also TOP AV-IPFV~English only
 ‘Mary also speaks only English.’ (✓ in discourse A, # in B)
- b. Si Mary **lang** ang nag-i~English **din**.
 NOM Mary only NOM AV-IPFV~English also
 ‘Only Mary also speaks English.’ (# in discourse A, ✓ in B)

The crucial test case is what happens if we try to express these meanings in a structure with only one clitic domain, where *din* and *lang* form part of a single clitic cluster. This possibility is illustrated in (33) below. As Kaufman (2006, 2010b) reports (as in (30) above), both “*din lang*” and “*lang din*” orders are possible, although in this particular structure *lang din* seems to be slightly more natural. For both word orders, however, the interpretational facts are the same: this example can only be used to express the second sentence in discourse A, not B.

(33) ***Din lang* in a cluster can only express “also > only”:** (Hsieh and Erlewine, to appear)

- Nag-i~English {**lang din** / ?**din lang**} si Mary.
 AV-IPFV~English only also also only NOM Mary
 Judgement: ✓ in discourse A, # in B
- a. ✓ ‘Mary also only speaks English.’ =(32a)
 b. * ‘Only Mary also speaks English.’ =(32b)

The interpretation of example (33) forms an argument against the cluster-internal ordering of adverbial clitics strongly reflecting their underlying structural heights, as per Kaufman’s observation regarding (30) above or as would be expected based on a syntactic derivation as in Tanenbaum 2020a,b. First, recall that *din* and *lang* are one of the few adverbial clitic pairs that allow for variable word order as in (30). However, this does not reflect a flexibility between the two in their structural positions; instead, *din* ‘also’ necessarily takes scope over *lang* ‘only’ when they are in the same clitic domain. Second, for the attested reading in (33a), the availability of both word orders indicates that there is no strong preference for a scopally transparent order. Such examples strongly support the view that cluster-internal ordering is established extrasyntactically, largely based on (27) and (30) as conventionalized templates, rather than reflecting their underlying syntactic positions in any systematic fashion.

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